Task 4:

As a Coach

Health SMART goal: Enhancing her ability to cope and lowering her anxiety levels to improve her emotional control in high jump **environments** were my client's two main health SMART goals. I sought to improve her psychological resilience and control her arousal levels through planned mental training sessions that included progressive muscle relaxation, deep breathing, visualization, and mindfulness. These techniques were chosen because, whereas visualization and mindfulness concentrate more on enhancing focus and mental control during performance, deep breathing and progressive muscular relaxation helped regulate physiological arousal. She showed notable improvement in emotional regulation and stress management on the ACSI test, going from an initial score of 35 (moderately low coping ability) to 44, exceeding her target range of 40-45. Furthermore, she achieved her goal by improving her BSMASS finding from a high anxiety level to a moderate range and then a low range within moderate. Her parasympathetic nervous system (PNS) was activated by lower anxiety levels, which decreased heart rate and over-arousal. This enhanced her focus, approach rhythm, and self-assurance during takeoff in competitive **environments**. While visualization mostly boosted her confidence by enabling her to mentally rehearse successful efforts, deep breathing seemed to be the most immediately helpful tactic because it let her quickly control her anxiety before jumping. Improving her focus and emotional stability during training also resulted from addressing her dependence on social media. Together with post- session reflections, the regular 10- minute sessions spread over five weeks to make sure that development was immediate and tangible. Overall, she showed noticeable gains in coping skills, anxiety management, and general mental preparedness for her high jump performance. Therefore, I think her health SMART goals were accomplished quite successfully.

health tests	Initial	interim	final	Target score
ASCI	35	39	44	(40-45)
BSMASS	High	Moderate	Low range at Moderate	Moderate

Physical SMART goal: By the end of the 8-session program, which lasted five weeks, my client identified five physical SMART goals she wanted to accomplish. The primary goal was to increase her high jump height by 0.05m, from 1.25m to 1.30m, which she accomplished in the final evaluation. Her take-off power and flight posture were directly improved by the planned training regiment, which included plyometric exercises, lower-body resistance and strength training, along with targeted dynamic and static stretching to increase hip and thoracic spine flexibility. She demonstrated enhanced explosive triple extension at the ankle, knee, and hip joints as her vertical leap improved from 0.33 to 0.37 meters, above her 0.35- meter target. She recovered and surpassed her goal by completing at 1.85m, demonstrating increased horizontal force output, despite her standing long jump slightly declining at the interim stage (1.82 to 1.81). She met her goal and increased her approach velocity from improving her 30m sprint time from 5.25s to 5.23s. Finally, her sit and reach score increased from 23 to 28cm, surpassing her 27cm target. This improved her flexibility, decreased the rick of bar contact, and supported improved high jump performance overall. `as a result, I think she successfully met all of her physical SMART goals within the time frame provided

Fitness tests	Sit and Reach	Vertical Jump	Standing long Jump	30m Sprint	High Jump
Initial	23cm	0.33m	1.82m	00:05.25s	1.25cm
Interim	27.5cm	0.36m	1.81m	00.05.24s	1.27m
Final	28cm	0.37m	1.85m	00.05.23s	1.30m
Target score	27cm	0.35m	1.84m	00.05.23s	1.30m

Training plan Effectiveness:

Successes: Several significant accomplishments during the training process demonstrated the high jump training plan's efficiency. The obvious boost in confidence, especially during the Fosbury Flop's takeoff and flight stages, was one of the biggest successes. Performance in both gym and field **environments** was initially impacted by anxiety, but confidence and focus considerably improved with regular application of visualization, mindfulness, progressive muscle relaxation, and positive reinforcement. Higher ACSI scores and lower BSMASS anxiety demonstrated this progress, which directly supported the psychological SMART target of improving coping and reduced competitive anxiety. Visualization had the biggest effect of boosting confidence through mental repetition. Stronger takeoffs, smoother bar clearance, and more controlled approaches were all direct results of this psychological development. Physical gains were also noticeable, as plyometric training and progressive loading improved lower body strength, endurance, and explosiveness, enabling higher takeoff power. Plyometric exercises were successful because they directly improved jump performance by simulating the explosive triple extension during take-off. Coordination, rhythm, and overall performance were further enhanced by organized warm-ups, distinct phase breakdowns, and a decrease in outside distractions (such the use of brown noise). Furthermore, video analysis demonstrated better body placement over the bar and validated technical progress, particularly in lumber hyperextension during flight, as **communicating** through a **digital environment** enabled detailed visual feedback and more precise technical evaluation. Reaching the client's physical SMART goals, especially in the high jump, was another significant accomplishment. The client exceeds their goal of 1.30 meters by increasing their clearance height from 1.25 to 1.30 meters. With drills on approach rhythm, penultimate stride, and triple extension having the most effects on clearance height, this demonstrates that the training achieved the physical SMART goal. This was a definite sign that the technical exercises that emphasized forceful triple extension at the ankle, knee, and hip during takeoff, approach, rhythm, and penultimate stride mechanics were successful. My client also showed an apparent boost in lower-body strength, as seen by a 4cm rise in her vertical jump height. The training program was successful in focusing on the essential elements for a successful bar clearance because of the general improvement in leg strength, coordination, and core stability.

Challenges:

Despite these achievements, a few problems had risen which forced the training program to be alternated. The drills were initially too rapid for her developmental stage because her current skill level was not considered during the planning process. This resulted in

timing errors and irregular rhythms throughout the approach phase. The gym's weights were occasionally excessively high, which negatively affect her technique In a few exercises, confidence, and depth; also, the initial plan overestimated her physical capabilities. Slowing down the pace, by adding more slow-motion walkthroughs, and making the demonstrations more repetitive and understandable were ways to solve the problem. From the excessively heavy weights, loads were lowered to prioritize technical excellence before gradually increasing overload again. The first introduction of stronger breathing control into her movement patterns affect her stability during explosive movements. The use of structured breathing cues and verbal cues was driven by the strong influence that higher breathing control strengths had on stability during explosive movements. Consistency was also diminished by interruptions and occasionally unclear directions. As a result, **communication** was enhanced and controlled distractions were progressively introduced to increase attentional focus in training **environments**. In order to minimize misunderstanding in future training programs, I would add breathing and stability signals from the start, adjust loads based on progressive testing, set up drills with more precise development stage evaluation, and structure **communication.**

Interpersonal Skills:

By developing strong interpretation skills was essential to identify my client's technical strengths and areas for improvements during the high jump training process. One of my most important skills was analyzing performance signals, which allowed me to recognize trends in both spoken feedback and physical motions, such as unpredictable takeoff positioning, irregular approach rhythm, or poor coordination during the flight phase. By paying close attention to body alignment, foot placement, takeoff angle, and timing, I was able to spot situations where performance was hampered by technical problems rather than a lack of effort or confidence. For example, when her final stride was too short, I told her to "extend it fully and land on the ball of your foot" to improve takeoff. During the flight phase, bar clearance was made easier by my advice to 'raise your hips and tuck your chin'. With this information, I was able to adapt my coaching approach by breaking down challenging exercises into manageable courses and tailoring routines to my clients' ability level. I advised her to "count your steps, maintain a steady rhythm, and slow your approach" in order to facilitate a smooth transition into the flight phase. As a result, approach and takeoff drills were modified to increase vertical force, speed control, and penultimate stride. For example, I modified the approach and takeoff drills to emphasize controlled speed, appropriate penultimate step mechanism, and effective vertical force production in order to facilitate a more seamless transition into the flying phase. I was able to provide accurate targeted feedback that promoted technical development while maintaining the client's confidence and motivation by employing these interpretation strategies.

Collaboration Skills/ Professional Relationship:

One of the main ways I ensured the high jump training program altered was by including my client and encouraging her to engage instead of just following the instructions that was given. I enhanced the coach-athlete **relationship** and created an **environment** that promoted open **communication** by routinely asking for feedback and finding out which drills were efficiently working, and which my client was struggling with. When approach drills appeared exhausting, I advised, "Slow full run-ups or add focused penultimate step-ups drills" she liked slower run-ups, so we gradually integrated into the training sessions. Later on, I suggested transitioning to plyometric activities when strength training became boring. For example, when approach drills seemed tiresome and weren't improving takeoff consistency, we collaborated to negotiate modifications that added flexibility while keeping the technical factor. In collaboration, we tracked our progression, as a coach and client, recognizing our strengths and areas for improvement. When isolated penultimate step drills did not make my client achieve the results we aimed to see, we changed to controlled full-approach run-ups. As a result, we were able to maintain an engaging and effective training schedule while progressively enhancing rhythm, coordination, and confidence. We worked together to make changes so that those three elements were positively increasing throughout the training sessions.

Throughout this process, ongoing **communication** was essential, especially via Padlet (Figure 4.1), a **digital environment** where my client frequently contributed thoughts, inquiries, and opinions outside of training sessions. Instead of depending only on face-to-face observation, this ongoing enabled me to identify trends in their issues and development over time. I was able to change activities to enhance rhythm; coordination, and control between phases and adjust the training **environment** to better meet their needs by studying movement patterns and written reflections. With the use of these analytical abilities, I was able to give insightful, timely comments that improved technical growth, fostered trust, and enhanced the bond between coaches and athletes.
(Figure 4.1)



IB Learner & ATL Skills Development: To establish a productive coach- client **relationship,** I used several IB learners and ATL skills during this coaching experience. I addressed questions like, "Which part feels most challenging?" and used my listening and engagement skills to pick up on my client's nonverbal clues, including hesitancy throughout the approach or changes in posture. I enquired, "Do you feel rushed" and changed the exercise tempo when I saw her shoulders stiffening before takeoff, which instantly improved her confidence and rhythm. This encouraged my client and I to **communicate and interact** openly, which contributed to the development of a reliable working relationship. I also demonstrated organization and self-management abilities by setting up sessions in advance, utilizing Padlet to track development, give feedback, and compare my coaching methods with her results. After a missed landing indicated fatigue, I created the next session using Padlet notes. I showed preparation and flexibility by switching between more straightforward plyometrics and technical drills to maintain quality. I periodically needed resilience and an optimistic outlook to shift my focus from height-focused workouts to ones that enhanced rhythm, coordination, and penultimate step timing. All things considered, these skills enhanced my ability to combine flexibility and methodical planning which helped both my client's high jump performance and my own coaching career. I developed as a communicator by tailoring my language and remarks to my client's needs, a thinker by assessing performance and changing tactics, and a principled learner by continuing to coach consistently and fairly. These ATL skill applications showed how reflective practice directly affects learning and performance by improving not only her skills but also my flexibility and decision-making

As a client

Health SMART goal: As a client, I initially did not realize the extent to which performance anxiety and low self-esteem, particularly played in competitive **environments,** in affecting my high jump performance. After completing the ACSI and BSMASS tests, it became evident that I needed to improve my ability to regulate my arousal levels and retain cognitive control under pressure. Elevated anxiousness was negatively impacted my concentration, tense muscles, and overall motor coordination, especially during the approach and take off phases. My coach addressed this by implementing psychological skills into my training program, which included visualization to improve mental rehearsal of proper biomechanical sequencing, meditation, and box-breathing. My ability to focus and control my emotions was enhanced by these techniques. My ACSI score increased from 52 to 63 as a result, putting me in the 52-61 target range which demonstrated greater resilience and coping mechanism as I overachieved the target score. My BSMASS score also increased from moderate to low, indicating a healthy performance-based mindset and less stress contends to my body. Overall, I had met my health SMART goal, exhibiting increased self-efficacy, intrinsic motivation, and psychological preparedness, all of which improved my athletic performance.

health tests	Initial	interim	final	Target score
ACSI	52	57	63	52-61
BSMASS	Moderate	Moderate	Low	Low

Physical SMART goal: My physical SMART objective was to increase my high jump performance by strengthening my muscles, flexibility, and speed. I improved my neuromuscular coordination and explosive strength with organized training sessions built on the concepts of specificity, progressive overload, and recuperation, by my coach, which directly contributed to my improvements. My 30-meter sprint time dropped from 5.50 to 5.43 seconds, exceeding my goal of 5.45 seconds. This suggests improved acceleration mechanics and increases horizontal velocity throughout the approach to run-up, likely due to repeated sprint drills and approach-run practices that ultimately improved my neuromuscular coordination and stride efficiency. During triple extension at takeoff, I was able to demonstrate improved concentric force production in my quadriceps and gluteus maximus muscles by increasing my vertical jump from 33.6 cm to 35.8cm, surpassing my aim of 35cm, being explained by strength-based and plyometric training that gradually overworked these targeted muscles. My sit and reach score grew from 22 to 28cm, meeting my goal and demonstrating better lower back and hamstring flexibility that allowed for a more effective spinal hyperextension throughout the Fosbury Flop's flight phase, as my training included regular mobility and dynamic exercises. Most importantly, I met my overall target heigh by improving my high jump performance from 1.33 to 1.40 meters. Through focused conditioning and technical improvement, I was able to successfully reach my physical SMART objective, demonstrating the successful transfer of speed training, plyometric strength training, and flexibility training into sport-specific performance.

Fitness tests	Initial	interim	final	Target score
30m sprint	5.50s	5.46s	5.43s	5.45s
Vertical jump (cm)	33.6cm	34.5cm	35.8cm	35cm
Sit and reach (cm)	22cm	25cm	28cm	28cm
High jump performance	1.33m	1.36m	1.40m	1.40m

Breakdown of High Jump Performance:

Phase	Initial Performance	Final Performance	Analysis (Strength+ Weakness) + Improv
Approach			Before takeoff, the approach is a crucial stage for building centripetal force and horizontal velocity. As demonstrated by my initial performance, I was unable to produce enough horizontal momentum because of my limited inward lean through the curve along with me knee lift, which was at an angle more than 90° (125°), surpassing the optimal angle (Wanda Diamond League, 2025). My erratice stride pattern hindered effective force transfer into the take-off phase and decreased rhythm. In contrast, I used a controlled J-shaped approach in my final performance, taking longer, more steady strides, around 8-12 strides (Out, 2020), along with bending my knees and hip at an excellent angle of 90°. My gastrocnemius and quadriceps were able to produce more propulsion as a result, increasing my horizontal velocity, which could then be transformed into a vertical lift. In my initial performance, the force in my leap depended more on my take-off leg alone than on full momentum transfer because my approach lacked

			controlled acceleration and inward lean, which had improved thoroughly to perform better in my final.
Take-off			For triple extensions to transform horizontal velocity into vertical impulse, the takeoff phase is essential. Triple extension was limited in my initial performance because my hip, knee, and ankle did not fully perform a proper knee flexion upwards into an optimal 90° angle, being specifically at a 78° angle, where the excellent angles are between 87° to 107° (Christensen et al., 2021). From not properly esxtending my arm swing to be overhead, this led to me producing less upward force, alogn with my take-off foot being unbalanced reducing ground reaction force. My center of mass was projected downward as a result of this. But in my final performance, my knee drive lifted to around 90°, meeting the expectations explained above. By fully extending my double-arm swing, I was able to improve force summation and increase vertical impulse. More vertical displacement and more explosive takeoff were made possible as a result. Reducing ground contact duration further would improve elastic energy return from the stretch-shorting cycle, even if it has already been greatly enhanced (Seiberl, n.d.).
Flight			The Fosbury Flop technique is used in the flight phase to measure how well the center of mass moves over the bar. I improved my thoracic and lumbar hyperextension as in my initial performance, i had an angle of 204°, which was eather close to 180°, a flat back angle limiting my spinal extension and my posture keeping my hips somewhat low. Where in final performance the angle had increased to a 232° angle, enahncing bar clearance. My centre of mass remained close to the bar due to my delayed knee time, which increased the risk of contact with the bar. On the other hand, I showed more spinal hyperextension and a more noticeable arch in my final performance, at a 232° angle, a more noticeable arc compared to my initial. I was able to segment my body over the bar by raising my hips above shoulder level, with flexing and extending my knees in harmony. My center of mass was more controlled as a result, and my body was able to clear the bar efficiently. Even though it had improved, more plantarflexion and a slightly sooner knee snap could maximize clearance even more.
Landing			For safe force absorption and injury prevention, the landing period is crucial. During my initial performance, I landed with an unequal body alignment, with asymmetrical leg positioning and minimal trunk flexion at 90°. The inability to completely control my arms resulted in less effective force dissipation

			across the posterior chain. This indicated that the impact of forces was not dispersed equally. I showed stronger bilateral mat contact, more controlled leg placement, and optimal spinal alignment in my final performance. Upon impact, my hips and knees were flexed to create a 45° angle with the upper body, keeping It in a tight position, minimizing injury risk, and efficiently absorb force. To further protect the cervical spine, a small adjustment would be to increase the flexion from the chin to the chest.

Collaboration Skills:

We worked together through passive **communication** in a coach-athlete **relationship**, which was crucial to my growth as a athlete and high jumper. Our **interactions** were centered on frequent **communication** and adaptations within the training **environment.** When certain aspects of the flight, particular the curved approach and takeoff, appeared rushed and unbalanced rather than being firm and stable, which then I spoke up about. Throughout collaboration we changed the training **environment** by introducing drills that separated the penultimate step and strengthened optimal take-off angles to aid me maintain horizontal velocity while converting it into a vertical lift. When my coach's video analysis revealed any weaknesses throughout my performance, especially in bar clearing, we then increased the number of sets for the approach runs and controlled jump in a workout to improve rhythm and spatial awareness in my training **environment.** These **strategic interactions**, led to transparency in our **communication,** and planned changed made within my training **environment** which greatly improved my technical execution and overall high jump performance.

Interpersonal Skills & IB Leaner Attributes:

During my high jump training, I frequently provided my coach with my personal input on the training session, which improved my training regimen and improved my overall performance for high jump. After every session, I though back on my performance and the exercises I performed and **interacted** to my coach about particular issues so we could make targeted adjustments. This was because I was either accelerating faster than I should have or improperly lowering my center of gravity before takeoff, which reduced my vertical impulse. Furthermore, I discovered that my curving approach and penultimate step were inconsistent during the training sessions. So, in order to improve stride patterns, speed management, and takeoff accuracy, we incorporated check-mark run-ups and curved rhythm drills after our reflection on my inconsistencies. It has also been mentioned that I was being cautious in arching my back efficiently over the bar when in flight phase, which prevented my hips from sinking and minimized my spinal hyperextension. We also added back-arc drills on the high jump mats, along with slow-motion take-off exercises that focus on technique, specifically, the arm swing, synchronization, and leg drive to help me improve my overall high jump performance. We also set short-term performance goals, such as consistently hitting my take-off mark or making controlled final strides, so that every session was effective and measurable.

Throughout this process, I developed the IB Learner traits of reflection and open-mindedness by continuously assessing my technique and implementing new exercises and strategies like box breathing and mental imagery. These techniques helped me focus and remain composed in both training and competition **environments**, ultimately assisting me in reaching my goal height of 1.40, which was 1.33 initially.

Summary: I can state with clarity that I consistently incorporated **Identities and Relationships** into every aspect of training. This is because of effective **communication** and passive feedback, both in-person and in a **digital society**, our **interactions** were more thoughtful and cooperative. By integrating technology and video analysis from a **digital society**, we were able to perform a comprehensive review of performance and make real improvements to the training sessions. The training **environment** evolved into a place of constant adaptability where technical knowledge, trust, and **communication** all worked together to maximize performance.